MISSION ARCHITECT TOOLKIT / SESSION 606

AI-ASSISTED PUZZLE DESIGN

Ideas for using generative AI to assist with puzzle mechanics and creation.



Make sure to use approved tools and non-sensitive, fictional material and test everything yourself!

PROMPTS TO COPY AND ADAPT

01 IDEATE

Given [observable behavior], [audience], and [time/material constraints], propose three paper-based escape-room mechanics. For each, explain exactly what players decide, why that demonstrates the behavior, and what could go wrong.

02 DRAFT

Using ONLY [fictional scenario] and [supplied reference criteria], draft [number] clue or decision cards, one justified intended solution, two plausible distractors, and a simple self-check. Mark all assumptions and missing information.

03 CHALLENGE

Review these draft puzzle materials as a skeptical first-time player. Identify ambiguous clues, multiple valid solutions, rule violations, unintended shortcuts, and accessibility concerns. Flag what must be tested with real participants.

04 REFINE

Rewrite instructions in Goal → Do → Check format. Propose two increasingly specific hints, a time-up recovery path, and a debrief question that connects the decision to a new but comparable situation.

HUMAN VALIDATION: THE NON-NEGOTIABLE STEP

- ☐ Solve independently; verify every rule and the intended answer.
- ☐ Look for unsupported clues, contradictory constraints, and accidental shortcuts.
- ☐ Test the actual print pieces and hints with someone new.
- ☐ Check access, difficulty, and alignment before adding visual polish.

REAL DEVELOPMENT LESSON

During development of a workplace learning game, AI-generated logic-grid clues sometimes left multiple valid answers, while AI-drawn patrol routes violated movement rules. The designer revised the clues, drew correct routes, and independently verified the finished puzzles.

AI ATTRIBUTION Artwork generated with OpenAI tools; AI-assisted text reviewed and edited by the author.